



Gucci's Luxury Wellness Ring

Luxury brand Gucci has joined hands with Oura to release a \$950 premium health tracking ring. <https://digit.in/jun22-26>



Meta updates its Privacy Policy

Facebook owner Meta has updated its privacy policy. It will be in effect from July 26, 2022. <https://digit.in/jun22-28>



The drawings on these devices were illustrated either on a strip or a disc and could be seen as moving images when the wheel of the device was spun. The figures would keep moving until the device lost momentum or until it was stopped by the user. The 20th century was ruled by flipbooks and mutoscopes, in terms of animation. And soon after, cinema and television took over. And that's when the physical proximity to animated images increased, until the advent of video games and computers brought animations closer to the viewer once again.

During the early days of the internet, GIFs were highly influenced by the new designs of the internet and vice versa. In the 90s, the internet was filled with websites which had visually noisy backgrounds, and some under construction signs. The average human interaction with GIFs were mostly the under construction signs on websites with some cute animated symbols or icons.

UNDER CONSTRUCTION SIGN

GIFs started to gain popularity when the early web browser Netscape, Mark Anderson's browser became the only browser to allow the user to interact with images; which when clicked would take you to another tab and would make you aware of some new information. In 1995, when Netscape navigator 2.0 was launched it supported the format of .Gif and even animated GIFs. These GIFs provided a way to design your websites and one

could also download them, without using up much storage space.

In the same year, CompuServe announced a licensing agreement with Unisys after knowing that the LZW compression method was under patent. After years of giving GIFs for free, the company suddenly decided to charge a small royalty for softwares which used the algorithm.

In response, the League for Programming Freedom launched a campaign, "Burn all GIFs". Which encouraged all the GIF users to shift to patent free PNG files. So on 5th November, 1999 all developers gathered together to delete their GIF files. Although, Unisys only asked large companies for royalty and not the individual users, developers still felt the patent was a threat. The patent expired in 2003.



BURN ALL GIFS IMAGE

Even after this campaign, the GIFs survived. Partly, because of its uniqueness in providing animated images. As in the 90s, GIFs had already started to make their mark through the means of some popular and viral memes such as, the dancing baby. Another popular meme at the time was the Hamster dance website.

During the early 2000s, when the web started to evolve, GIFs started to be considered tacky. This led to the development of other methods of transmitting videos and images in a more sophisticated manner.

The mid-2000s brought about a proliferation of social media platforms such as Myspace, Facebook and Youtube. These platforms required

clean and simple designs to appeal to their users. And by this time the patent had also dissolved, so the GIFs entered the public domain, and certain websites allowed users to create their own GIFs.

2007 saw the launch of Tumblr, which allowed its users to post GIFs of file sizes as large as 500KB. This was later increased to 1MB in 2012. Tumblr can also be considered responsible for reigniting the mainstream interest in GIFs, and for curating the #GIF tag. It created more interest towards aesthetically pleasing GIFs, which were mostly 2D or 3D geometric shapes, collages, coloured illustrations, glitch based etc.

And coming to the modern world, GIFs have now become more like reactions. It has become easier than ever to create a GIF. By simply screen grabbing images or videos, converting them, adding text and done! You have successfully created your very own GIF. Modern GIFs have become internet lingo and are being used in the cultural lexicon to give out reactions.

With GIFs coming a long way, from its early days to BURN THE GIF, and now to reaction GIFs that fill up our chat windows. What the future will look like for GIFs is hard to say. Technologically speaking, GIFs are easy to use, but more than anything else, they are an ideal way of expressing feelings. It has had its share of ups and downs but through all that, GIFs have constantly stayed popular and have somewhat become a cultural icon without most people even realising it. So here's to the GIF on surviving 35 years! [d](#)

